

Visit Bucket Methodology — April 15, 2026

Pre-filter applied to all visits: dropped any visit with fewer than 2 user actions to remove bots and accidental landings. Started with 722,043 raw visits, kept 588,437 for classification.

Each visit is assigned to exactly one bucket using a first-match precedence rule. Buckets are checked in order — once a visit matches, it stops. The summary below is sorted by share of total; the detailed definitions that follow are in precedence order.

Summary

Bucket	Visits	% of Total
Search User	388,755	66.1%
Independent	51,625	8.8%
Designer	39,075	6.6%
Centralized Buyer	32,427	5.5%
Account Curious	28,765	4.9%
Shared Login	28,715	4.9%
Multi-Platform	15,236	2.6%
Payment Agent	3,840	0.7%
Total	588,437	100.0%

Bucket Definitions (in Precedence Order)

1. Payment Agent — 3,840 visits

The back-office person who handles paperwork on behalf of orderers. They never place orders themselves; they download invoices, packing slips, material certificates, and check tracking numbers for orders that other people in their company placed.

How we identified them: the visit had post-order success activity (any document download, tracking lookup, or cert save) AND did not place an order today.

Why first: downloading order documents is a highly specific behavior — if you see it, this is what they came for.

2. Designer — 39,075 visits

The engineer or product designer who comes to McMaster to grab CAD models for parts they're designing into a product. They may never order through McMaster — someone else handles purchasing.

How we identified them: the visit had at least one successful CAD download AND did not place an order today.

Why second: saving CAD is a specific behavioral signal of intent. Wins over customer-profile labels because the persona is defined by behavior, not customer state.

3. Search User — 388,755 visits

The person who uses McMaster as a reference catalog. They might browse, copy part numbers, print pages, or forward info to a colleague — but they don't have an account relationship with us. Either they're not logged in, or they once touched the order pad but never placed an order so the system has no record of them as a customer.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor_id is either missing entirely (never touched the order pad), or has no contact record attached (touched the order pad but never ordered).

Why third: once we've ruled out the specific behavior buckets, anyone without a customer record is functionally a search user.

4. Account Curious — 28,765 visits

The person who created a McMaster login but has never placed an order. They poked around in the system enough to get a contact record, but they've never shipped anything, so they have no ship-to address on file.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor has at least one contact record, but that contact has zero ship-to locations on file, AND the visit didn't place an order today.

Why fourth: sits between Search and the real-customer buckets — they're more than a search user (they have a login) but not yet a real customer (no ship-to).

5. Multi-Platform User — 15,236 visits

The same person showing up across multiple McMaster platforms — mcmaster.com, the iPhone app, mobile web, punchout, etc. They use whichever channel is convenient.

How we identified them: the visitor_id appeared on 2 or more distinct platforms across April 15.

Why fifth: this is a person-level behavior pattern, weaker than visit-level behavior. Sits above the customer-profile buckets because cross-platform use is more interesting than profile alone.

6. Shared Login — 28,715 visits

Multiple people at the same company share a single McMaster login. They might each order for their own desk but all under the same account credentials.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor_id is linked to 2 or more distinct contact records — meaning multiple real people have ordered under the same login. This is exactly how the data warehouse encodes shared accounts.

Why sixth: customer-profile signal, deferred behind visit-level and person-level behaviors above.

7. Centralized Buyer — 32,427 visits

One person who places orders for many ship-to locations within their company. The whole company funnels purchasing requests to them, and they submit the orders.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor is linked to exactly 1 contact record (one login, not shared), and that contact has shipped to 2 or more distinct locations historically.

Why seventh: customer-profile signal, requires single-login plus multi-location.

8. Independent / Individual User — 51,625 visits

The "normal" customer. One person with their own McMaster login, ordering parts for their own desk or workbench, shipping to one location. This is the residual bucket — anyone with a clean single-login, single-ship-to profile who wasn't caught above.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor has exactly 1 contact and 1 ship-to location, OR the visit didn't match any earlier bucket. Includes a small group (~2,000) of first-time orderers whose ship-to record hasn't been fully built yet.

Why last: by design, this is the catch-all for normal-customer visits.